

The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

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Room #13, The Landing.

Opening the door reveals a room apparently designed as a landing for several flights of stairs to culminate. Several other flights of stairs lead off into the gloom in several directions. Some of these flights of stairs collapsed, some appear usable but could be dangerous, and others appear sturdy and well used. Upon the north and south walls are a flight of stairs that are each choked with rubble. A clear flight of stairs upon the eastern wall descends at a sharp 55° angle. Within this stairwell is a Drow character painted in dark red paint.

The symbol indicates that this stairwell is safe. The stairwell on the southern wall is artfully choked off, and clearing the rubble takes four rounds (during which time the DM should roll random encounters at least once). At the DM's discretion, some of the other stairs although cracked and fallen into disrepair may lead to expanding this dungeon complex.

Room #14, the first arch.

When the characters enter the room at the bottom of the stairs, read the following paragraph. If the characters did not encounter the Drow, modify the following paragraph omitting reference to the characters knowing that there is a riddle within this room.

At the bottom of the stairs is a room that is 15' square with an arched roof 15' high at the peak. The dimly lit room has a shimmering arch of fine stone that comprises the eastern wall. This stone arch is 12' high at the peak and spans eight feet. Between the spans of the arch is a shimmering veil of light that ripples like water. Along the other three walls of the room, are tidy carved stone shelves rising from floor to ceiling. Filling every shelf are various skulls of every type and size. The arrangement of the skulls is from smallest at the top to the largest at the bottom. Some of the skulls are from races easy to identify, while others are giant, specimens from species you surely hope no longer reside in these halls. Two odd things strike you as you stand within this room. The first is that there is a small brass plaque nailed to the forehead of each skull. The plaques are smooth, plain and although polished to a high luster. The other is that there is supposed to be a riddle around here somewhere but you fail to see one.

Searching the room fails to reveal any riddle, but discovers a small, untrapped lever on the western wall. Pulling this lever causes a section of the floor to open. Read the following paragraph.

After pulling the lever, a small section of the floor in the center of the room opens and a beautiful stone statue rises from the depths of the floor. This statue is of a beautiful woman dressed in long, loose robes with her arms raised as if to embrace a lover. On her head is a rusty iron headdress in the shape of a scorpion. Clinched within the claws of the scorpion is a large diamond (value determined by the DM). At the base of the statue is a short paragraph.

The paragraph is written in an ancient language requiring ancient language proficiency or a *Read Languages* spell to read. Once translated, the paragraph reads, "Mighty Selket²⁰, protector of the dead." Searching the statue for secret or hidden things reveals that the scorpion's tail upon the head of the statue is a lever, and that the diamond is securely mounted. In order to free the diamond, the iron scorpion will have to be damaged possibly ruining it. Casting a *Detect Magic* spell reveals that the statue, scorpion, and diamond are very magical. The skulls are not magical and may be removed from the shelves.

Pulling down upon the tail of the scorpion causes the diamond to light up equivalent of bright sunlight. The beams of light stream from the gem in a silent barrage of light, striking the brass plaques upon the skulls. This light display causes several lines of verse to float in the air at chest height. Written in the same language as the words upon the base of the statue, these lines of verse and require another *Read Languages* spell or ancient languages proficiency check to read. Once translated the lines of verse are a riddle:

"What creature walks on four legs in his morning?
Two legs in his afternoon
And three legs in his evening?"

The answer is man, human, or mankind spoken in the same language as the riddle. Speaking the correct answer activates the teleportation arch, and characters stepping into the arch are immediately teleported to room #15.

Characters that destroy more than three skulls (each has seven hp), destroy the statue or scorpion, or displace more than seven skulls render the statue inoperable and it will not display the riddle. Removing the diamond or destroying the iron scorpion also renders the statue inoperable. Removing more than four plaques from the skulls also renders the statue inoperable. Depending upon the skill level of the players, the DM might want to hint that greedy players not take the diamond, or the characters will not be able to operate the teleportation arch. An alternative is letting the players destroy skulls, remove the diamond (value determined by the DM), and any other notion but teaching them that such actions have consequences by deactivating the arch. These characters are going to have to back track and utilize some other portions of the dungeon to work around the inoperable teleportation arch. Using this option, the DM must be ready to expand the dungeon and decide if the characters are going to be able to attain the goals of this

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adventure after rendering the first teleportation arch inoperable. One more alternative is applying a two percent penalty for each skull or plaque that the characters deface. When the characters activate the statue displaying the riddle, apply the cumulative penalties to the chance that the riddle will be scrambled, missing words, or very faint.

The Forgotten Halls, Level 3

Room #15, a warm welcome.

When the characters arrive in the new room, read the following paragraph. If the characters did not enter this room by going through the teleportation arch, modify the description of this room.

You arrive in a small room identical to the previous, except that, this room lacks a teleportation arch, and the macabre decoration. This room is incredibly hot, rendering infravision useless. A single flight of stairs descends from the eastern wall at a gentle 15° angle.

The temperature in the room is 165° Fahrenheit. Exiting the room by descending the stairs reveals that the temperature drops to near underground ambient temperature at the bottom of the stairs. Searching the very hot room reveals nothing of interest.

Room #16, the first sleeping room.

Entering this simple stone landing reveals that the room might have been designed as a rest area. The room is 15' wide and 10' deep with a ceiling nine feet high. Along the northern wall are several rows of stone benches that appear designed for sleeping. At the end of each bench is a small fireplace displaying heavy use that warmed the sleeping benches, where the smoke exhausts to is unknown. Upon the southern wall is a small water fountain containing brackish yellow water that a strong smell of sulphur emanates from. Descending from the eastern wall is another flight of stone stairs descending at a gentle 15° angle. At either end of the room, the remains of twin wooden doors are evident, but the doors and the assumed crosspieces are missing.

Where and when the doors disappeared is unknown, but obviously was done with great force. Perhaps they were smashed into bits and burnt in the fireplaces under the sleeping benches to warm other travelers. Obtaining water purified by magic from the fountain is possible, but not enough obtained in this manner to support up to six characters under heavy exertion. However, water obtained here and at the previous location in the chasm will retard damage, and may reduce penalties suffered at the DM's discretion.

Room #17, the second sleeping room.

When the characters enter this room read the following paragraph.

At one time, this room was identical to the previous room, but it has suffered severe damage in the past. The ceiling has partially collapsed creating a mound of rubble in the center of the room, revealing a large natural cavern above this room. A small puddle of yellow brackish water lies in the center of this room around the rubble pile, fed by a small stream that trickles from the natural cavern along the southern wall. This room has a sharp repugnant odor, as if rotting old meat mixed with the strong smell of sulphur. Descending from the eastern wall is another flight of stone stairs. The doors are also missing from this room, and the sleeping benches are probably buried under the rubble in the center of the room.

The cavern over this room is home to a female drider cleric. She will wait for the characters to give her a chance to attack from the rear by dropping a *Globe of Darkness* upon the largest concentration of characters. She attacks from cover, with surprise and a higher position giving her a +4 bonus to her initial attack and +2 to subsequent attacks. The drider is more than 50% concealed forcing the characters to suffer a -4 penalty to their attacks. Other than exiting the room, the characters are unable to gain any shelter within the room.

Drider cleric: INT 17; AL CE; AC -2; MV 12; HD 6+6; hp 45; THAC0 13; #AT 1; Dmg 1-4 or by weapon; SA poisonous bite does 1d4, save versus poison at -2 or be paralyzed for 1-2 turns; SZ L; ML 14; XP 5,000; Monstrous Compendium; *Drow Composite Short Bow* +2; *Footman's Mace* +2; *Drow chain mail* +3; 23 arrows poisoned with Drow sleep poison, (renders victim unconscious unless a successful saving throw versus poison is made with a -4 penalty which lasts 2d4 hours) four arrows poisoned by same poison as bite; two *Potions of Healing*; Spells: *Combine*; *Cure Light Wounds* (x2); *Detect Good*; *Purify Food and Drink*; *Augury*; *Slow Poison*; *Spiritual Hammer*; *Locate Object*.

Stashed within the cavern is 124 gp, and 1,324 gp in various small semiprecious and precious stones and small pieces of art. Concealed under a small pile of rocks are a pair of *Potions of Extra Healing*, the cleric's prayer book, and three vials of Drow poison. Madame Nova knew about this drider and purposely did not tell the adventurers about her hoping that either the characters would kill the drider, or the drider would kill the adventurers proving they were unfit to trade with. Madame Nova traded with the drider in a mutually beneficial relationship that was not friendly, but lately the drider began attacking members of Madame Nova's enclave and refusing to abide by a previous agreement. It is

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unlikely that the characters would ever learn these facts, unless imparted by the DM, but there is possibly more intrigue here that could be expanded to fit the DM's campaign.

Room #18.

After the characters, descend the stairs, read the following to the players.

This large room has had the door smashed in some time in the past and its crushed ruin lies upon the floor just within the entrance. The room is 20' wide and 15' long with a flat even roof 12' that has suffered damage and a limited collapse with a large pile of rubble under the damaged area. Scattered within the room are several small items. Three partially-used torches, three partially-used black tallow candles, a broken iron bone-handled knife, a fancy embroidered scabbard for a dagger, a rotting stuffed black cat, and a dented pewter mug.

Searching the room and the articles reveals nothing of interest or value. The stuffed animal is similar to what a child would play with, and despite the rot and mold, is in decent shape. The scabbard could still be used, but the leather is starting to rot and would not last long. Completely digging through the rubble takes approximately six rounds (during which the DM should roll for random encounters twice) and reveals a crushed orcish skeleton underneath the rubble.

Exiting the room upon the ? side is a down-ward sloping smooth passage that descends at a steep 25° angle. At the bottom of this passage is a cross roads where the carved passage bisects a natural cavern (room #18).

Room #18, the natural cavern.

Looking into the depths of this room reveals that it is immense, and some areas of the cavern are beyond the range of your sight. To the east you can hear the faint sounds of trickling water. Surrounding the area where the sound of water comes from is a large fungi forest containing several different species of mushrooms. Some of these mushrooms tower over eight feet high, while others are quite small. The air within the room smells strongly of rotting eggs (sulphur).

Characters entering the room, notice that the air is damp and cool. Entering the fungi forest, there are several edible species and a character with a botany or underground specialty that the DM determines could be of help could gather enough edible mushrooms to support the characters. Searching the fungi forest reveals nothing of interest other than the edible mushrooms. However, there are several species of poisonous mushrooms, and characters that blindly pick mushrooms are in danger of eating a deadly mushroom.

Exploring the sounds of water reveals a sluggish, yellow-stained murky sliver of water that winds through the room. The polluted water contains high amounts of heavy salts, sulphur, iodine, and selenium. Water purified by magic from this river could support the characters if the DM desires, but the adventure is written so that there is not quite enough to support the characters, but enough to barely maintain life and prevent damage. As the characters explore the muddy edges of the water, four scraggs hiding within the mushrooms leap to the attack.

Scraggs (4): INT 6; AL CE; AC 3; MV 3; Sw 15; HD 5+5; hp 44, 40, 36, 33; THAC0 15; #AT 3; Dmg 2-5/2-5/3-12; SD regenerate only when immersed in fresh water; MR Nil; SZ L; ML 14; XP 650; Monstrous Compendium.

The scraggs are not going to be able to regenerate since there is no water, and will flee if damaged enough to threaten their life. Searching the area around where the scraggs attack reveals numerous semiprecious stones that when all are collected yields 29 gp in various, small-uncut stones. Searching this portion of the room for secret or hidden items reveals a leather and wooden pack frame hidden under some dead mushrooms. Searching the pack frame reveals three tin flasks of barely wine sealed with red wax, a *Potion of Extra Healing* in a glass container clearly marked, three rusty iron spikes, an ornate silver whistle (worth 4 gp), four glass vials of lamp oil, a useable but dented bulls eye lantern, and a tin box containing tinder and flint. For further expansion, the DM can expand the natural cavern to the west later.

Room #20.

This room is 25' long and 15' wide and appears to be a natural cavern that was squared out. The walls are for the most part made of natural stone while the floor and 12' high ceiling are worked stone but were left rough with tool marks evident on both. Upon the northern wall is a large, curved stone arch nine feet tall and spanning six feet at the base. The area between the arch and wall contains a shimmering curtain of light. Just in front of the center of the arch, etched deeply into the floor are a series of words spelling and ancient riddle.

Written in an ancient version of the common tongue that the characters can read with a successful Intelligence check, the short riddle reads:

“What has a face, but no eyes
Hands, but no fingers?”

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The correct answer is a clock, timepiece or watch spoken in the same language as the riddle is written. Speaking the correct answer activates the teleportation arch teleporting the characters to room #20.

The Forgotten Halls, Level #4

Room #21, the charnel house.

Upon arriving within this room, the first two things that you notice is the awful stench of death, and that you have arrived in this room standing upon the remains of the losers of a large battle. The large dark cool room is 30' long by 25' wide and has a smooth flat roof nine feet high. The southern wall has a single opening within it revealing a hallway leading from this room. At one time, there was a door covering this exit on the southern wall, but it disappeared a long time ago. Standing among these dead, some are starting to move.

Within this collection of dead are 6 sword wraiths, 33 skeletons, and 25 zombies. The sword wraiths are the remains of a professional band of mercenaries that died here millennia ago in a forgotten battle. The wraiths attack all who enter this room, and occasionally prey upon the rothe in room #24, and other travelers in these halls.

Wraith, Swordwraith (6): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 7+3; hp 44, 28, 30, 49, 35, 36; THAC0 13; #AT 3/2 (as 7th level fighter); Dmg 1d10; SA Strength drain; SD +2 or better weapon to hit; SZ M; ML Fearless (19-20); XP 650.

Skeleton (26): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 1; hp 3x5, 4x4, 5x7, 3x2, 3x6, 4x1, 3x8, 3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-6 (weapon); SD immune to sleep, charm, hold spells & cold, 1/2 dmg from P & S weapons; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

Skeleton, Warrior (1): Int. 15-16 Exceptionally intelligent; AL NE; AC 2; MV 6; HD 9+2; hp 45; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg By weapon type (+3 to attack rolls); SA Flee in panic (creatures with less than 5HD); SD Only hit by magical weapons; SZ M; ML Champion (15); XP 4,000.

Skeleton, Monster (6): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 6; MV 12; HD 6; hp 24, 36, 29, 21, 22, 25; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg Special; SA Use giant weapons (but no strength bonus); SD immune to sleep, charm, hold spells & cold, 1/2 dmg from P & S weapons; SZ L, H; ML Fearless (20); XP 650.

Zombie, Common (23): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2; hp 6x6, 2x9, 13, 3x12, 11, 4, 4x7, 5, 16, 10, 14, 8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8; SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

Zombie, Cannibal Corpse "Hungry Dead" (3): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL NE; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2d10; hp 17, 7, 5; THAC0 18; #AT 1; Dmg 1d6; SD Special; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 350.

Like zombies, they are immune to sleep, charm, hold, and cold based spells. Except in their animation concentrated area, the hungry dead are immune to physical attack. The area of concentration is usually the head but at the DM's discretion, it could be any part of the body (heart, stomach, etc.).

At first, "to hit" rolls of a natural 19-20 are needed to affect them (simulating an attack to one particular area of the body). After the first attack accidentally succeeds, the PCs should realize the problem and try to aim for the vulnerable area; using called shots, etc.

Clerics have the same chance to turn hungry dead as they do ghouls.

Note: there is such an unnatural hunger that once a victim is slain, 1d4+1 hungry dead will stop attacking to feed on the slain victim. Hungry dead will not eat other undead, only fresh slain corpses.

Found within the room are 13 pp, 244 gp, 17 sp, 46 cp, and 245 gp in miscellaneous small gems. Searching the room for secret or hidden items reveals a secret compartment at the base of the western wall. The secret compartment is locked but not trapped. A matched pair of *Throwing Daggers* +3 is stashed within the secret compartment. Leaving the room, there is a noticeable rise in temperature, humidity and the sound of pouring water emanates from farther down the hall. The strong smell of sulphur emanates from the other end of the hall.

Room #22, the boiling subterranean waterfall.

The door to this room has disappeared a long time ago, although you can see where the door once sat. The room beyond the door is hidden by a cascading boiling waterfall that falls from a large crack in the roof just inside the doorway. The water pours from the room towards the left through another large crack in the floor although it forms a small wide pool in the area that is shallow. The area around the waterfall is very warm and humid. The area around the